



T-storm 87/66 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 90/71 B20

Democracy Dies in Darkness

THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 4, 2025 • \$4

Florida plans to end vaccine mandates

Would be the first state in nation to require no student immunizations

BY DAVID OVALLE AND LORI ROZSA

Florida's surgeon general on Wednesday announced plans to end all state vaccine mandates, including for children to attend schools, which would make it the first state to completely withdraw from a practice credited with boosting vaccination rates and controlling the spread of infectious diseases.

Speaking at a news conference outside Tampa with Gov. Ron DeSantis (R), Surgeon General Joseph A. Ladapo said that every vaccine mandate "is wrong and drips with disdain and slavery" and called the rollback "the right thing to do." Ladapo's stances on vaccines and other measures intended to protect Floridians have drawn criticism from public health experts and advocates.

"Who am I as a man standing here now to tell you what you should put in your body?" Ladapo said Wednesday.

DeSantis, who at the news conference endorsed Ladapo's measures, acknowledged ending certain vaccine requirements would "require changes from the legislature."

Florida law mandates students must be vaccinated against polio, diphtheria, rubeola, rubella, pertussis, mumps and tetanus, while allowing exemptions for religious and medical reasons. Getting rid of those would require lawmaker approval. The Florida Department of Health could more immediately target four vaccines mandated under its own rules: chicken pox, hepatitis B, Hemophilus influenzae type b (Hib) and the pneumococcal vaccine PCV 15/20.

The Trump administration and Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., the founder of an anti-vaccine organization, have been pushing to upend U.S. vaccine policy. Florida's move underscores the deepening political fault lines

SEE VACCINES ON A6

Covid and flu: FDA questions safety of getting the vaccines together. **A6**



MATT MCCLAIN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Danielle Bensky, at center left, embraces Anouska De Georgiou as survivors of Jeffrey Epstein's abuse gather on Capitol Hill.

Epstein accusers call for disclosures

This article is by Amy B Wang, Mariana Alfaro, Kadia Goba, Marianna Sotomayor and Katie Tarrant

About a dozen accusers of convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein joined House lawmakers and a crowd of hundreds at the U.S. Capitol on Wednesday to push for the Justice Department to release all of its files related to its investigations of the disgraced financier and of his imprisoned associate Ghislaine Maxwell.

Women join lawmakers to demand release of files by Justice Dept.

In emotional testimony, the women — some of whom were speaking publicly for the first time — recounted how they were lured as teenagers into an elaborate sex-trafficking operation run by Epstein and Maxwell and abused for years.

All voiced their support for lawmakers to pass the Epstein Files Transparency Act, a rare bipartisan measure led by Reps. Thomas Massie (R-Kentucky) and Ro Khanna (D-California) that would compel the Trump administration to publicly disclose far more documents on Epstein.

At least 201 Democrats had signed on to the discharge petition as of Wednesday afternoon. As of that time, only three other Republicans besides Massie — Reps. Lauren Boebert (Colora-

do), Marjorie Taylor Greene (Georgia) and Nancy Mace (South Carolina) — had joined Democrats.

Wednesday's news conference was the first time accusers of Epstein and Maxwell have come forward as a group since the start of a polarizing debate this summer over how much information the Trump administration can and should release about the government's long-running investigation into the matter.

SEE EPSTEIN ON A8

Judge says Harvard's funding cannot be withheld

BY SUSAN SVRLUGA, JOANNA SLATER AND LAURA MECKLER

A federal judge ruled Wednesday that the Trump administration violated the Constitution by freezing federal research funding at Harvard University, dealing the White House a setback in its efforts to force change at the country's oldest university and higher education nationwide.

U.S. District Judge Allison D.

Administration likely to appeal ruling, which says it violated Constitution

Burroughs said freezing and canceling more than \$2 billion in research grants and other federal actions violated Harvard's First Amendment rights and amounted to "retaliation, unconstitution-

al conditions, and unconstitutional coercion."

Her ruling, which is likely to be appealed, vacated the government's funding freeze and barred it from using similar reasoning to block grants to Harvard in the future.

The government's actions had terminated nearly a thousand federal grants at Harvard, threatening cancer research and innovations in multiple fields such as quantum computing and efforts

to lessen the consequences of battlefield injuries. The Trump administration had said its actions were necessary to compel the university to do more to combat antisemitism.

Burroughs also granted Harvard's request for summary judgment on civil rights law, ruling that the administration had not followed the requirements of Title VI, which bars discrimination on the basis of race or national

SEE HARVARD ON A15

Putin and Kim at his side, Xi stages massive show of force

BY CHRISTIAN SHEPHERD AND LYRIC LI

BELJING — Chinese leader Xi Jinping, flanked by the heads of Russia and North Korea, delivered a muscular show of force Wednesday, showing off new-generation weapons and sending a message that China is rising to challenge the global leadership of the United States.

Xi welcomed the leaders of 26 countries, including a smiling Russian President Vladimir Putin and North Korea's Kim Jong Un, into the stands overlooking Tiananmen Square in central Beijing for the country's largest-ever military parade, marking 80 years since victory in World War II.

"The Chinese nation is a great and self-reliant nation that is never intimidated by bullies," Xi told the crowds, emphasizing the contributions of China, Russia and other non-Western countries to winning what Beijing calls the

"War Against Japanese Aggression and the World Anti-Fascist War."

In recent weeks, Beijing has been recasting history to downplay the United States' role in ending World War II while playing up the contribution of China and the Soviet Union.

President Donald Trump, writing on his Truth Social platform as the parade got underway, urged Xi to "mention the massive amount of support and 'blood' that The United States of America gave to China to help it to secure its FREEDOM from a very unfriendly foreign invader."

Suggesting he was put out by the display of chumminess and firepower, Trump continued:

SEE CHINA ON A11

Rare insight: Beijing parade offers window into military program. **A10**

North Korea: Kim fuels succession chatter by bringing daughter. **A12**



NOAH BERGER/AP

Wildfires rage in California

A resident works to stop flames consuming a home from spreading to a neighboring house Tuesday in the community of Chinese Camp in California's Tuolumne County. Thunderstorms and dry lightning caused dozens of blazes to break out in central and northern areas of the state. **Story, A3**

House to start new inquiry of Jan. 6

GOP SAYS PREVIOUS PANEL WAS BIASED

Speaker pledges to seek 'full truth' on Capitol riot

BY KADIA GOBA AND PAUL KANE

House Republicans voted on Wednesday to establish a new subcommittee to reinvestigate the Jan. 6, 2021, attack on the U.S. Capitol, moving to reopen one of the most polarizing chapters in American politics.

Lawmakers slipped a resolution into a rule on the House floor that would establish the subcommittee, which is likely to be headed by Rep. Barry Loudermilk (R-Georgia). Republicans have complained that the previous probe was biased against President Donald Trump, who has repeatedly denied he lost the 2020 election to former president Joe Biden.

Democrats said they weren't aware the resolution had been added to the rule until it was debated in Rules Committee on Tuesday night.

Rep. Jamie Raskin (D-Maryland), a member of the first committee that investigated the attack on the Capitol, said in a statement: "We welcome yet another chance to remind Americans of House Republicans' ongoing complicity with — and embarrassing apologetics for — MAGA's violent insurrection against Congress and Vice-President Mike Pence and Trump's sinister attempt to overthrow a presidential election."

The resolution would establish a select subcommittee under the House Judiciary Committee with a total of eight members to be appointed by House Speaker Mike Johnson (R-Louisiana) and not more than three to be appointed "in consultation" with

SEE SUBCOMMITTEE ON A4

Missouri: DOJ asks local officials for 2020 voting machines. **A20**

GOP weighs raft of bills to intervene in D.C. policies

BY MEAGAN FLYNN AND JENNY GATHRIGHT

House Republicans are weighing a slate of legislation that would overhaul criminal justice policies in D.C. and further restrict home rule — including a proposal that would remove the city's locally elected attorney general and replace him with a presidential appointee, according to a draft summary of the policies shared with congressional staffers and obtained by The Washington Post.

Republicans on the House Oversight Committee are considering the 14 proposals against the backdrop of President Donald Trump's ongoing effort to federalize local police and crack down on crime, immigrants and quality-of-life issues in the nation's capital while deploying armed National Guard troops on the streets. The draft proposals are not final and could be subject to change before the committee meets to vote on them, which

SEE GOP ON A15

IN THE NEWS

U.S. government sued Survivors and families of victims of a 2023 mass killing in Maine accused the Army of ignoring warning signs posed by a reservist behind the attacks. **A3**

D.C.'s legal logjam The Superior Court often stays in session well after sunset because of President Trump's federalization order. **B13**

THE NATION Democrats are racing to set a proactive agenda to help win back the House in 2026. **A5**
A bid to censure a House Democrat over an immigration facility incident fell short. **A8**

THE WORLD With a related law set to pass, Australia made a deportation deal with an island nation. **A16**
Trump sent a message by destroying a suspected drug boat from Venezuela, Rubio said. **A16**

THE ECONOMY ICE has reactivated a contract with a spyware vendor that had been banned under the Biden administration. **A13**
Smaller doses of GLP-1 drugs can extend longevity, proponents claim, but critics warn of a lack of evidence behind the "craze." **A14**

STYLE Artist Amy Sberald is taking her canceled Smithsonian exhibition to the Baltimore Museum of Art. **B1**

SPORTS The Commanders' rookie wideout Jaylin Lane, the son of a coach, has carved out a niche in his first camp. **B7**

THE REGION Maryland Gov. Wes Moore (D) signed an executive order aimed at increasing affordable housing in the state. **B13**

LOCAL LIVING Frank Lloyd Wright's iconic Fallingwater is leaking. A \$7 million renovation that is underway aims to stop it.

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